

CHAPTER

1

EATING FOR LIFE

A Nutrition Plan that Works. Forever.

I have tried many different nutrition programs over the years, both with my clients and for myself. I've achieved a certain amount of success with several of them, especially at first. That's because many of these diets work very well in the short term. But virtually all of them fail over time. Why? Here are a few reasons:

- **COMPLIANCE**—Many of these programs are challenging to sustain. Sure, if you cut calories super-low, you're going to immediately lose weight. In fact, you may lose quite a bit of weight in a short period. After all, that's what these diets are predicated upon. What happens is you drop water weight and muscle mass very quickly, and you also shed a small amount of fat, although not as much as you probably think. It takes some time to really crank up your body's fat-burning system, and even then it's a slow grind. So, that means much of your quick weight reduction comes from reducing water and muscle mass, things you actually don't want to lose.
- **TOO MANY MEALS**—Many nutrition programs require you to consume multiple small meals a day. These programs are based on the principle that consuming multiple small meals up your metabolism and help reduce hunger. That's because you have an influx of calories coming into your body many times per day. Some of these diets rely on six or more meals each day and often you never get to consume a proper meal. So, though you're eating all the time, you're never satisfied. All these small meals also put stress on your digestive system, which is hard on the body, an issue I'll explain in more detail later.

- **LIMITED FOOD CHOICES**—Some of these programs have very limited food choices. Which at first works really well and are easy to do, but within a few days these become monotonous. When you dread your next meal your program is doomed.

There is a better way. And that's where my plan comes in.

HOW “SUPERHERO NUTRITION” WORKS

This book will provide you with my personal program, the one I use with many of my clients. But the beauty of my plan is that if you eat vegan, vegetarian, Paleo, raw food, ketogenic, lactose intolerant, or even if you follow Weight Watchers or any other popular diet, your food choices will work with my system.

Superhero Nutrition is a two-part system:

Part 1: The timing of your meals, workouts and sleep, which is the backbone of the program.

Part 2: What you actually consume every meal.

Part 1 is the most important aspect of my program; if you are eating at the wrong times, no matter how clean your diet is, you won't be able to achieve or maintain your goals. I believe that the way my plan puts your meals together is the most efficient and long-term answer to getting you to lose bodyfat like a superhero.

Do not fear if my foods aren't exactly what you want to eat. My system will guide you to making the perfect choices from the foods you *do* eat. Together we will achieve the goal of getting you in the best shape of your life.

I promise!

HERE'S MY PLAN

I'll go into more detail in Chapter 3, but here are the nuts and bolts of my program.

- 1) **You'll eat 2-3 meals a day.** You choose the meals.
- 2) **You'll space your meals 5-6 hours apart** with no snacking in between.
- 3) **You *will not be limited on how much quality food you consume* at meals,** because you'll have "free" foods, such as salads, to include in your meals.
- 4) **You can follow any other program so long as you adhere to my program's rules.**

This means you can incorporate diets such as Weight Watchers, South Beach, or lifestyle preferences, such as vegan and vegetarian.

5) **I believe you'll have even greater success** if you adhere to certain critical guidelines of my program, including:

- my hand-ratio recommendations;
- the glycemic-load principles (which I'll explain later).

In the end, the choice is up to you whether or not you want to follow my food recommendations. The most

crucial thing about Superhero Nutrition is my unique timing plan. I'll explain the reasons why this works in the next chapter.

SUPERHERO STORY: The Yo-Yoing Actor

★ I started training an actor who was stressed because he had just finished filming a movie and was worried that he wouldn't be ready to play a superhero in his next project in six weeks. So he asked me if he should just eat boiled chicken and salad every day for lunch and dinner and then an apple for breakfast. "I've done it before, and I got in shape," he said.

So I asked him what happened after he stopped eating that way, he laughed and told me he couldn't stop eating carbs and gained 35 pounds quickly afterwards. Then I asked him if he wanted to do it my way and not only get camera-ready but never break down again. He decided to try my program and he's kept the fat off ever since.

WHY OTHER PLANS FAIL OVER TIME

So, you've cut the total number of calories you consume each day. And you've lost 10-20 pounds over the past few weeks. That's good, right?

Yes. That's terrific! But now you have to ask yourself a really difficult question: Can I maintain this program for the rest of my life?

If the answer is no, then you're simply going to gain back the weight you lost. And here comes worse news: You're likely to add even more weight than before you began the diet if you return to your previous eating patterns.

Why? Your metabolism is out of whack because you took in so few calories during those small meals for the past few weeks. While you've successfully lost weight, you've also likely reduced muscle tissue, because your body prefer-

entially burns muscle over stored fat when you're in starvation mode.

Now, when you return to your "normal" eating patterns, your body needs fewer calories per day for activity, and then it will store the excess as bodyfat. It's a vicious cycle that yo-yo dieters often encounter.

Let's say you've fallen into this trap, the way Hollywood stars used to do many years ago—and that continues today, as well. What should you do next? You need to teach your body how to properly manage an appropriate amount of food each day, allowing it to use this fuel to support health and activity without storing it as bodyfat.

That's true whether you've failed on ridiculous diet plans before, or if you've

decided to take control of your nutrition program, levels of bodyfat and overall weight for the first time.

SUPERHERO STORY: The "Hangry" Woman

★ I used to train a woman at my gym who was always angry (hangry?), and everything made her upset. Mad about her job, friends and people that got in her way on the street; you name it. So one day she told me how she had not had a good date in over a year. She then explained how she had been on an Intermittent Fasting program for the past year.

"Ah, ha!" I thought to myself, you don't eat for 18 to 20 hours a day then you only have a 4-6-hour window where you can eat whatever you want. She was so unhappy with her nutrition program that it bled into all aspects of her life. Other people in the gym would tell me that they did not want to be around her because she was always in a bad mood. This is no way to go through life just to be in great shape. Your nutrition program should make you feel energetic, happy and not tired and miserable. Mine will help you feel much better. I promise.

WHY SUPERHERO NUTRITION WORKS

Several years ago, I began to investigate other eating strategies that freed me from having to prepare and consume all of those tiny meals with so little satiety. Back in 2007, I wrote a book, *The 30-Minute Celebrity Makeover Miracle*, in which I recommended that you shouldn't eat for an hour and a half before exercising.

Not eating food for an hour and a half before exercising allows your insulin levels to stabilize. When insulin levels are high, our bodies do not burn fat for energy. That's a simple fact. And the advantage is that the intense calorie demand during training will encourage your body to release fat from storage.

At that time, a light bulb went on over my head. That was the answer! It's all about our bodies' insulin release. Everything else is secondary. I had figured out the solution to permanent fat loss back in 2007, but I hadn't fully understood its importance. That's because I hadn't yet figured out how to fully apply the concept to a sustainable nutrition program.

Now I have.

In the next chapter I'm going to explain all the ins and outs of how insulin works, and how this potent hormone affects you when you follow any nutrition plan. This explains the reasons why virtually all other plans fail in one way or another over time, and why you'll succeed on my program. It's all about timing, and you can integrate any other plan into mine so long as you emphasize timing over calories and foods.



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SUGAR